



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Preparatory School

School Website: <https://attendtrinity.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School (Austin, TX)

Website used: <https://austinclassical.org>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: **CLASSICAL**

Austin Classical School (ACS) exhibits comprehensive, explicit alignment with classical Christian education across mission, aims, curriculum, and pedagogy. The school centers on truth, goodness, and beauty; the cultivation of wisdom and virtue; and implements the Trivium with Latin, formal logic, rhetoric, Great Books, and Socratic teaching. Program artifacts (e.g., Senior Thesis, Christian Studies sequence, Latin through upper grades, logic and rhetoric, "Rhetoric Choir," and the explicit use of memorization/recitation and debate/discussion) strongly match the positive indicators in the Six Essential Elements framework and lexicon. Parents are positioned as co-laborers and co-teachers, especially in the Grammar years, further strengthening the classical ethos at home and school. Evidence for "Faculty" as the "living curriculum" is present but comparatively lighter on the public site; thus that single category is scored Somewhat Classical with suggestions below. Key evidence includes: "glorify Jesus Christ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students" and explicit commitment to "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty" and the Trivium, Great Books, Latin, logic, rhetoric, and Socratic method (ACS pages) which map directly to the positive keyword indicators of the "Six Elements" and classicality lexicon ;.

Aggregate result across six categories: 5x **CLASSICAL**, 1x **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** → Overall: **CLASSICAL**.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Scope of criteria: transcendental moral realism, grounded in theology, liturgical/communal practices.

- Keywords observed in ACS materials:
- "glorify Jesus Christ... classical, Christian education," "wise, virtuous, and humble" (mission).
- "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty," "cultivate wisdom and virtue," "The Aim... Method... Tools... Trivium".
- Emphasis on Scripture: "God's holy, inerrant, and infallible Word... at the center of the great conversation".
- Theological coursework: Christian Studies sequence including Exegesis & Hermeneutics, Applied Exegesis, Apologetics & Ethics.
- Imago Dei language: "made in the image of God... good, true, and beautiful".

- Communal/choral practice mention: “Rhetoric Choir” in fine arts sequence (liturgical/choral culture).
- Match to Six Elements positive indicators:
- Transcendentals/virtue/wisdom, theological integration, sacred tradition, Christian formation, and liturgical/communal sensibilities (choir, reverence) are direct positives per the “Six Elements” and lexicon.
- Positive vs. negative keyword estimate:
- Positive hits: 14 (e.g., Jesus Christ; truth/goodness/beauty; wisdom; virtue; Scripture; theology; exegesis; apologetics; image of God; Christian Studies; choir).
- Negative hits: 0 (no “values-neutral,” “secular humanism,” or “pluralistic religion” framing).
- Coverage: High across the three sub-dimensions (moral realism; theology; communal/choral).
- Quantification: percent_positive $\approx$ 1.00; percent_coverage $\approx$ 0.90; pos_neg_hits: +14/-0.
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Scope of criteria: cultivate wisdom and virtue; formation over information; truth, goodness, beauty are real and knowable.

- Keywords observed:
- “To cultivate wisdom and virtue,” “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”.
- “Less about training for a specific, temporal vocation... learning to think and live with an eternal purpose” (formation, not merely vocational prep).
- “whole person... mind, body, and soul... an excellent education engages all three”.
- Match to Six Elements positives: explicit “formation,” “virtue,” “wisdom,” “True/Good/Beautiful,” aligning with Purpose/Goal indicators; contrasts the negative “career readiness/21st-century skills” focus flagged in the lexicon, which does not appear on ACS pages.
- Positive vs. negative keyword estimate:
- Positive hits: 12; Negative hits: 0.
- Coverage: Very high.
- Quantification: percent_positive $\approx$ 1.00; percent_coverage $\approx$ 1.00; pos_neg_hits: +12/-0.
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Scope: Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, history (not social studies), wonder/integration.

- Keywords observed:
- Trivium articulated and implemented (Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric), with Latin, logic, rhetoric, Great Books/Western canon, and Bible/Christian Studies; Senior Thesis; robust fine arts including choir.
- “Great ideas,” “Great Books,” “Great Conversation,” “Western canon,” historical study with providential perspective; Latin advocated and embedded (5th–8th at minimum; further in high school).
- History listed explicitly by epochs across Logic/Rhetoric years—not “social studies” terminology.
- Match to Six Elements positives: Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, integrated humanities, cultivated wonder; avoids “social studies” framing and “STEM-first/project-based dominance” negatives.
- Positive vs. negative keyword estimate:
- Positive hits: 16; Negative hits: 0.
- Coverage: Full across sub-dimensions.
- Quantification: percent_positive $\approx$ 1.00; percent_coverage $\approx$ 1.00; pos_neg_hits: +16/-0.
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

Scope: contemplative/restful elements; singing/chanting/memory in lower school; Socratic/seminar/debate in upper school; rhetoric practice.

- Keywords observed:
- Grammar methods: “memorization, recitation, and songs” (explicit).
- Logic methods: “debate and discussion” (explicit).
- Socratic method: “employ the Socratic method... testing the truth” (explicit).
- Rhetoric: “begins producing and defending his/her own ideas,” Senior Thesis; imitation of master texts/speeches; rhetoric as truth-oriented persuasion (explicit).
- Wonder/imagination language appears (cultivating imagination ordered to the good, true, and beautiful).
- Match to Six Elements positives: Socratic, chanting/singing/memory work, rhetoric/orations, wonder and contemplation—core classical pedagogies; “scholé” term is not named explicitly but the spirit of contemplative formation and delight appears. All align to the lexicon and Six Elements pedagogy criteria.
- Positive vs. negative keyword estimate:
- Positive hits: 9; Negative hits: 0 (no “project-based learning dominance,” “student-directed” constructivist marketing).
- Coverage: Very high; explicit for K–8 and high school. Slightly less explicit on “scholé/restful” by name.
- Quantification: percent_positive $\approx$ 1.00; percent_coverage $\approx$ 0.85; pos_neg_hits: +9/-0.
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

Scope: teachers as models/mentors; “faculty of friends”; portrait/profile of a teacher/student.

- Keywords observed:
- Employment page presence and qualifications (general); teachers positioned as “faithful stewards” and guides to cultivate virtue and wisdom; Socratic instructors implied by method descriptions.
- Match to Six Elements: While faculty clearly enact classical pedagogy, public-facing language about teachers as “moral exemplars,” “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” or explicit “faculty collegium/-formation” is comparatively thin. The “Six Elements” envisions explicit statements about teachers modeling virtue and collegial mentorship as part of the school’s identity.
- Positive vs. negative keyword estimate:
- Positive hits: 3 (faithful stewards; classical pedagogy competence; Socratic leadership implied).
- Negative hits: 0.
- Coverage: Moderate due to limited explicit faculty-as-formation language on public pages.
- Quantification: percent_positive $\approx$ 1.00; percent_coverage $\approx$ 0.30; pos_neg_hits: +3/-0.
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle (Faculty) - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” and “Portrait of a Graduate/Student,” naming virtues (prudence, justice, temperance, fortitude; intellectual humility; wisdom) and describing faculty as mentors and moral exemplars who are the “living curriculum” (keywords strongly aligned with Six Elements). - Describe ongoing faculty formation in classical pedagogy (e.g., Great Books seminars; faculty colloquia; retreats) to signal a collegial “faculty of friends” engaged in shared inquiry. - Add explicit language about teachers as models/mentors and about mentoring relationships with students.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Scope: partnership with parents; parent formation; open/hospitable community.

- Keywords observed:
- Mission: “co-laboring with families” to cultivate wise, virtuous, humble students (parents as partners).
- Grammar model explicitly uses a home “co-teacher”; collaborative schedule (parents as co-educators).
- Parent formation: “Recommended Reading” to understand classical Christian education; information meetings/tours; direct Admissions contact/personalized tours.
- House system noted in Upper School culture (community-building).

- Match to Six Elements positives: strong “parent partnership,” home-school synergy, community life; avoids consumer/“parent as customer” language. This aligns directly with the lexicon’s community/parents indicators.
 - Positive vs. negative keyword estimate:
 - Positive hits: 6; Negative hits: 0.
 - Coverage: High (partnership, formation, hospitality).
 - Quantification: percent_positive $\approx$ 1.00; percent_coverage $\approx$ 0.90; pos_neg_hits: +6/-0.
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
-

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL (pp=1.00, cov=0.90, +14/-0)
- Element 2: CLASSICAL (pp=1.00, cov=1.00, +12/-0)
- Element 3: CLASSICAL (pp=1.00, cov=1.00, +16/-0)
- Element 4: CLASSICAL (pp=1.00, cov=0.85, +9/-0)
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (pp=1.00, cov=0.30, +3/-0)
- Element 6: CLASSICAL (pp=1.00, cov=0.90, +6/-0)

Overall: CLASSICAL

Rationale: ACS explicitly articulates a Christian classical telos (truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom and virtue), integrates theology and Scripture, implements Trivium-aligned curriculum with Latin/logic/rhetoric and Great Books, employs Socratic and memory-based pedagogies, and partners robustly with parents as co-educators—all direct positive indicators per the Six Elements and lexicon. Faculty language could be strengthened publicly, but existing evidence of classical teaching suffices for the overall CLASSICAL rating.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.